

49

HOURS PER WEEK
Is what more than 51 per cent of Indian employees clock, according to latest ILO data. This makes us the second among countries with the highest percentage of people working long hours

1.3

TIMES
The risk of stroke among people who work more than 55 hours a week compared to those who work 35-40 hours, according to a WHO-ILO study

62

PER CENT
of employees in 1,000 companies CII and MediBuddy surveyed reported work-related stress and burnout

$14

BILLION PER YEAR
Cost Indian employers bear due to poor employee mental health, per a 2022 Deloitte report

"The expectation of bosses that you see and respond to every message immediately compounds stress"



- DEVIKA DHARMARAJ
Instructor at Mental Health First Aid, India

long hours—more than 51 per cent of Indian employees work more than 49 hours per week or nearly 10 hours daily in a five-day work week. The modern workday has ceased to have any clear beginning or end, courtesy 24x7 communication technology—leaving an employee tethered to their phone or email. The boss's expectation for an employee to see and respond to every message immediately compounds the stress, says Devika Dharmaraj, an instructor with Mental Health First Aid India.

Along with the interconnectedness of the device came the integration of the world and the rise of the service economy, which saw Indian companies catering to the rest of the world and employing people to work in shifts and across time zones. Deadlines began to be dictated by external factors—primarily the clients—and became even more unreasonable, leaving companies with little power to negotiate work schedules, explains Aditya Mishra, CEO and managing director of HR solutions firm CIEL HR. This was especially